



DEPARTMENT OF PUBLIC SAFETY GEORGIA STATE PATROL

PURSUIT CRITIQUE

TROOPER NAME – SGT Doug Shamblin #485

Work Assignment: Troop/Division - A; Post/Unit – 38 - Rome

INCIDENT REPORT # DPS00147502

Related Crash Reports: _____ ; _____ ; _____

P.I.T. Involved: No

S.C.R.T. Involved: No

Special Investigations Unit Involved: No

Use of Force Involved: Yes

MEETING

1. Document the date, time and location of the pursuit critique meeting with the involved trooper.

Date: 4/9/2024

Time: 1200 hours

Location: Post 3 - Cartersville

2. List all personnel present at the meeting by name and rank. Include the trooper, an NCO in whose territory the pursuit was terminated, and the trooper's immediate supervisor.

Personnel present: Lieutenant Tim Nichols #36, SFC Chris Harris #753 and SGT Doug Shamblin #485

INITIATION

1. Provide the date and time the trooper became involved in the pursuit.

Date: 2/15/2024

Time: 2259 Hours

2. Explain the circumstances that led to the trooper's involvement in the pursuit.

On 2/25/2024, at approximately 2259 hours, SGT Shamblin was patrolling Hair Lake Road in Chattooga County, when he observed a white Toyota Tundra traveling at a high rate of speed and failing to maintain its lane. As SGT Shamblin attempted to conduct a traffic stop on the Toyota, the driver turned into a private lot and attempted to flee behind a building. After almost becoming stuck in a muddy area, the suspect was able to make his way back to Hair Lake Road initiating a pursuit.

3. If trooper's involvement was the result of a request from another agency, provide details regarding the request.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

4. List the number and identity of other agencies and officers involved in the pursuit.

☒ N/A

If needed, list:

5. If other occupants were in the patrol vehicle, identify them and state their reason for being in the vehicle.

☒ N/A

If Yes, list:

6. Did the trooper take appropriate safety precautions?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

7. Did the trooper eliminate distractions such as FM radio noise?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

COMMUNICATION

1. If the reporting trooper initiated the pursuit by means of observing a violation and attempting a traffic stop, explain the communication that took place between the trooper and the CEO.

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: SGT Shamblin was patrolling by himself in Chattooga County when the pursuit initiated. SGT Shamblin contacted the Chattooga County 911 Center, and advised them that he was in a pursuit. SGT Shamblin provided his location and a description of the vehicle. He then contacted the Troop A Communications Center and advised them of the pursuit. Dispatcher Gervais received this information and created a CAD call for the pursuit.

2. Did the trooper relay pertinent information to the CEO including:

- Location and direction of travel.
- Description of the pursued vehicle.
- Number and description of occupants.
- Information regarding the use of firearms, threat of force, or other hazard.
- Options for terminating the pursuit.
- Observed danger to public safety.
- Any need for assistance.

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

3. Explain any communication that took place between the CEO and other law enforcement agencies or officers in the area.

☐ N/A Explain: Due to the shortness of the pursuit, there was no time for the Troop A Communications Center to conduct a broadcast to other Troop A Troopers. Dispatcher Cain contacted the Chattooga County 911 Center by telephone to confirm that they were aware of the pursuit and that they had assistance enroute.

4. If the reporting trooper became involved in the pursuit at the request of another agency, explain any communication that took place between the trooper and another officer of the requesting agency. Give details of communication between the CEO and the requesting agency regarding the location, direction of travel, nature of the offense, any pending warrants, and details of erratic driving behavior illustrating the potential danger to the public if the suspect is not immediately apprehended.

☒ N/A If Yes, explain:

5. Did the trooper articulate his observations?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

6. At the conclusion of the pursuit, did the trooper advise the CEO immediately, so other units would be familiar with the location to offer assistance, or slow in an effort to reduce the likelihood of further risk of injury to either a trooper or a member of the general public?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

7. Discuss any needed areas of improvement with the CEO.

☒ N/A If Yes, explain:

PURSUIT

1. Describe the route the pursuit traveled, its duration and distance.

Describe: The pursuit initiated on Hair Lake Road and traveled south before the suspect made a right turn and traveled westbound on Buice Lane. The pursuit terminated on Buice Lane when the suspect came upon a dead end. The pursuit traveled approximately 0.7 miles and lasted one minute and 7 seconds.

2. Were the trooper's actions during the pursuit objectively reasonable?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

3. If the pursuit traveled into another post's territory, explain whether the initiating trooper yielded to a trooper whose territory the pursuit was in.

☒ N/A If Yes, explain:

4. If the initiating trooper yielded the primary position to another unit, explain whether he proceeded to the termination point of the pursuit to provide guidance and information for the arrest of the violator.

☒ N/A If Yes, explain:

5. Explain if there were any factors during the pursuit that indicated the possible commission of a felony.

☐ N/A If Yes, explain: The actions of the violator during the pursuit support a charge of Felony Fleeing and Attempting to Elude.

6. Did the trooper articulate his observations?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

7. Did the trooper practice commentator driving?

☐ Yes

☒ No

If no, explain: The short duration of the pursuit did not allow time for commentor driving.

8. Did the trooper remain calm and professional during the pursuit?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

DRIVING SKILLS

1. Did the trooper use due caution when operating his vehicle during the pursuit?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

2. Were the driving skills/techniques initiated appropriately?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

3. Were the driving skills/techniques appropriate during the pursuit?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

4. Were the driving skills/techniques appropriate during termination?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

5. Did the trooper appear to experience adrenalin rush, tunnel vision, or any other internal/external factors?

☒ No

If Yes, explain:

6. Did the trooper get into the danger zone due to adrenalin rush, tunnel vision, or other factors?

☒ No

If Yes, explain:

EQUIPMENT

1. Were the blue lights and siren in operation during the entire pursuit?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

2. If the patrol car was equipped with wig-wag headlights, were they in operation during the entire pursuit?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

3. Was the in-car camera working properly?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

4. Was the trooper's microphone working properly?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

TERMINATION

1. Did the trooper continue the pursuit to a conclusion? If not, explain the reasons.

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

2. Was there a good probability of the suspect's arrest at a later time because of positive identification?

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

3. Articulate attempts taken by the trooper to utilize pursuit termination techniques, such as tire deflating devices, roadblocks, P.I.T. maneuver, and trooper discretion.

☒ N/A

Explain:

4. Expound on safety precautions utilized by the trooper during and after the pursuit.

☐ N/A

Explain: SGT Shamblin utilized all his emergency equipment during the pursuit and operated his vehicle in a responsible manner. However, he failed to wear his seatbelt throughout the pursuit.

5. Articulate the existing traffic conditions during the pursuit, realizing the conditions may differ at various times during the pursuit.

Explain: The pursuit occurred during nighttime hours with clear skies and a dry road surface. The traffic conditions on all roads traveled during the pursuit would be described as light.

6. Address whether there are any conditions that would create additional danger to the public by continuing the pursuit.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

7. Address whether there were any conditions that necessitated the pursuit being brought to an immediate conclusion and describe the conditions.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

8. Establish whether the violator was an immediate threat to the trooper, the public or themselves.

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: The violator drove at excessive speeds, drove on the wrong side of the road through curves and over hillcrests and turned his headlights off just prior to making the right turn onto Buice Lane. The violator showed no regard for the safety of himself or his passenger.

9. Outline whether the use of deadly force was justified and if so, why it was justified.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

10. Establish whether the method of termination was reasonable based on the facts gathered during the pursuit, and state those facts.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

11. If there were any injuries, state who received them, the type and severity.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

12. If there was a fatality, provide basic facts surrounding the circumstances.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

13. Address any damage to vehicles.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

TROOPER'S ABILITIES AND EXPERIENCE

1. Prior pursuits (compare if appropriate).

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: SGT Shamblin has been involved in numerous pursuits during his career as a Georgia State Trooper.

2. Past use of techniques and high speed driving.

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: SGT Shamblin has received E.V.O.C. and Advanced E.V.O.C. Training.

ISSUES ADDRESSED

1. Positives.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

2. Areas for improvement.

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: SGT Shamblin should make every effort to notify and provide information to the Troop Communications Center upon entering into a pursuit or emergency situation.

3. Other considerations.

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: Before and after the pursuit, SGT Shamblin drew and displayed his service weapon. A Use of Force Report was completed.

RESPONSE FROM TROOPER OR SUPERVISOR

1. Allow trooper and supervisor an opportunity to respond or add comments.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

CORRECTIVE ACTION TAKEN

1. Describe any corrective action taken as a result of the trooper's actions during the pursuit.

☐

N/A

If Yes, explain: SGT Shamblin was issued a Letter of Instruction for failing to wear his seatbelt during this pursuit. A counseling session was held with SGT Shamblin on the importance of notifying the Communications Center when entering into an emergency situation.

Lt. T. L. Nichols #36

Reviewing Officer

Lt. T. L. Nichols #36

4/18/2024

Date